

Aboriginal Studies 30



Urbanization and its Effects – Leah Dorion

<http://interactive-learning-objects.onlea.org/mapping/#/painting/painting-4>

Theme 3

Aboriginal Peoples in Canadian Society

Resources Required:

- Documentary: *Reel Injun* by Neil Diamond
- Aboriginal Studies 30 Textbook: *Contemporary Issues*

Tawaw (Cree for welcome)

It is important to take a moment to recognize Elk Island Public School Division respectfully acknowledges we are located on Treaty 6 territory, a traditional gathering place for diverse Indigenous peoples including the Cree, Blackfoot, Metis, Nakota Sioux, Iroquois, Dene, Ojibway/ Saulteaux/ Anishinaabe, Inuit, and many others whose histories, languages, and cultures continue to influence our vibrant community.

Miigwetch (An Ojibway word for giving thanks)

Acknowledgment and Thanks

This document has been modified from an original created by C. Shepherd of Bev Facey High School. Many thanks to Mrs. Shepherd for generously sharing her resources, expertise, knowledge, and kindness. Maarsii! (Michif for “thank you”)

Student Work

Although it is impossible for settler society to fully comprehend the impact of colonialism experienced by Indigenous Peoples of Alberta and Canada, it is important to uncover how colonialism has led to racist, prejudicial and discriminatory treatment of Indigenous Peoples. This module takes a look at Indigenous Peoples in Canadian society and how cultural and leadership differences have led to misunderstandings and fostered negative stereotypes.

IN CANADIAN SOCIETY



Read pages 158-175 of your Contemporary Issues Textbook and answer the questions below.

I Didn't Know I was Different (page 158-158)

1. What are two examples of stereotypes that Jenine Dumont experienced? /2

2. How did stereotypes affect Jenine Dumont's self-esteem and self-confidence? /2

Alienation In Canadian Society (page 150-166)

Before we explore various concepts in more detail, please take a moment to solidify the meaning of some very important terms.

3. Define *multiculturalism* in your own words? /1

4. Define *assimilation* in your own words? /1

5. How do stereotypes form? /1

6. What harm can stereotypes do? /1

7. How does language contribute to stereotypes? /1

8. Describe the following types of discrimination (page 164-166) /18

Word	Description
Overt	
Covert	
Conscious	
Unconscious	
Institutional	
Subtle	

Blatant	
Verbal	
Non-verbal	

Language

9. How does language contribute to stereotypes? /1

Assignment 3.1 Breaking Stereotypes

Take a moment to reflect on stereotypes and the harm they do. What are some realistic ways that we as a society, community and individuals can overcome and break stereotypes?

Respond in paragraph form using the response criteria.

/16

Type or write your response below

Mass media

10. What roles do the mass media play in reinforcing stereotypes? /1

Let's go deeper into Negative Stereotypes in Pop Culture and Films



Most people see Disney's Peter Pan as a harmless children's story, but what about Tiger Lily and Indian Chief? Images such as these have fostered negative stereotypes.

Assignment 3.2 *Reel Injun*, by filmmaker Neil Diamond

/30



"In this feature-length documentary, Cree filmmaker Neil Diamond takes an entertaining and insightful look at the portrayal of North American Indigenous people throughout a century of cinema. Featuring hundreds of clips from old classics as well as recent releases, the film traces the evolution of the "Hollywood Indian." (National Film Board of Canada)"

Documentary Context

(taken from <https://tribecafilminstitute.org>)

Native Americans in Hollywood Film:

Since the era of silent filmmaking in the early 1900s, First Nations peoples have been used largely as props, the enemy, and comic relief in Hollywood films. The primary idea was that Indians were in the way of “progress” and “civilization” being achieved by colonial populations who sought to own and control all land inside the borders of what we now refer to as the United States.

Stereotypes and vocabulary often associated with Native Americans:

- Savage: Native people were described as villains out to scalp, kill and rape white settlers. Some were even thought to be cannibals.
- Noble Warrior: Stereotypical Native men were vicious and effective military leaders and hunters who fought to protect their people.
- Indian Chief: The European idea that Native tribes had a single chief who acted like a President, Prime Minister, or King at the top of a hierarchy and made all decisions on behalf of the group.
- Indian “Princess”: This term elevated the social status of Native women and was used to rationalize the desire of white men for Native women.
- Squaw: Stereotypical Native women were characterized as simple servants who cooked, cleaned, and birthed children for the men.
- Medicine Man: A romantic representation of the non-violent, land-based, “old ways” style spirituality that Native people practiced, which civilization seeks to destroy.
- Extinct: Belief that Natives, like dinosaurs, eventually died off due to disease, famine, genocide, and the inability to survive evolutionary changes.



Watch the documentary titled *Reel Injun*, by Catherine Bainbridge, Neil Diamond and Jeremiah Hayes.

[Reel Injun | Full Documentary | TVO Docs](#)



*Questions taken from NFB.com

*** **NOTE: In these questions & main point summaries, the terms Indian, First Nations, Aboriginals, Indigenous Peoples, Natives, Native American & politically incorrect “Injun” are used in reference**

to the filmmakers' choice & style of script writing. These terms are not meant to be insensitive in any way to modern correct terminology.

Native Representation *Reel Injun* – Chapter 1 @ 2:05 mins

Main points: Over 4,000 films shaped the image of the Native American in the last century, some offering stereotypical images, such as *They Died with Their Boots On*, others providing a more accurate focus, like *Little Big Man*, *One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest* and *Dances with Wolves*, and some that are free of stereotypes, like *Smoke Signals* and *Atanarjuat*. When Indigenous Peoples watch Indians on television and cheer for the cowboys, there is a major problem of representation. Distorted images have caused a great deal of damage.

1. What are the consequences of distorted representations of Indigenous people with regard to their identity, self-esteem and social and cultural development? /6

Native Americans from Hollywood to Wounded Knee Birth of the Hollywood Injun – Ch# 2

@ 10:45 mins

Main points: Early movie images depicted the “Injun” as spiritual, noble and free. In the late 19th century, Thomas Edison filmed Laguna Pueblo dances that were shown for a penny in the peep shows in Times Square in New York City. But while the “savages” in the reels were dancing, some 300 women, men and children were being killed in the Wounded Knee Massacre on the Pine Ridge Reservation.

2. Why would western culture treat Indians as myths or dinosaurs? /1

The Good Indian The Noble Injun – Chapter 3 @ 18:50 mins

Main points: During the silent-film era, Indians became stars. The Native American perspective was seen for the first time. Native filmmakers directed their own movies and brought their own people to play the characters. The Silent Enemy (H. P. Carver) explores starvation and the idea of the Native vanishing. In those days, it was cool to be portrayed as Native.

3. The silent era portrayed Native people as noble; how did that come to be? /1

4. Do you think that the kids in the summer camp sequence in Reel Injun were only encountered Native people in Hollywood movies? /2

5. According to Hollywood's criteria, what does it take to be a good or noble Indian? /1

Tonto speech and stereotypes The savage Injun – Chapter 4 @ 26:00 mins.

Main points: In the 1930s, Native people were portrayed as savages. Americans needed heroes, and John Ford's Stagecoach delivered the goods while also damaging the reputation of Native people and establishing a trend that lasted for decades: showing the savages constantly attacking the Whites. Instead of using actual Native languages, Hollywood developed the Tonto speech—or the art of speaking English backwards—and all the big stars played Native roles (Anthony Quinn, Charles Bronson, Boris Karloff and even Elvis Presley). After the film industry saddled Pocahontas with all the stereotypical notions that a mythical princess deserves, she became the embodiment of American society, not of Native society, just as Hollywood dressed Native characters like Plains Indians in buckskin and headbands, even though they do not use them in their culture.

6. By developing the Tonto speech, did Hollywood harm the existing Native languages spoken by US tribes? /2

7. What are some of the misguided notions surrounding the Indian princess Pocahontas? /3

A violent and Racist Icon The Cowboy – Chapter 5 @ 33:00.

Main points: A great icon of American cinema, John Wayne used violence with no mercy. But his actions seemed excusable, and they set the standard for how Indians should be regarded. “The kind of hunky white guy representing the moral standards of America, that is not real smart and that will do the right thing, chasing the Indians away, marrying the school woman and disappearing in the sunset.” (Jim Jarmusch)

8. When John Wayne shoots a dead Indian that was dug up from a burial ground in the eyes to make sure he will not be going to the spirit world, what kind of message is Hollywood sending? /2

9. What about the use of Native languages in the movies: Is it desirable in order to improve the pride and self-esteem of First Nations people? /2

Indians or human Beings? A Good Injun . . is it a Dead Injun? – Chapter 6 @ 38:15mins.

Main points: As a kid, Neil Diamond did not realize that Bugs Bunny was killing Indians, and

Graham Greene was doing the same thing when he would pretend to be Gary Cooper. On the other hand, Russell Means' brother refused to look at the Indians being slaughtered and fought white kids outside the movie theatre. "To erase the memory of being a human being, predatory mentality uses the word 'Indians' so Natives will lose track of the notion of being a human." (John Trudell)

10. Retrace the history and the meaning of this famously racist pronouncement by General Philip Sheridan: "A Good Injun . . . is a Dead Injun." Why would Hollywood use such neo-colonialist propaganda to confuse the feelings of young Native people? /2

11. Regarding the notion of human beings, why does John Trudell place so much emphasis on language as an instrument of war? /2

The American Indian Movement (AIM) The Groovy Injun? – Chapter 7 @ 49:20 mins.

Main points: In the 1960s, the hippies became Indians, trying to imitate them but at the same time trying to remember who they were and where they came from. The hostility of the media towards Native people subdued their spirit somewhat, but films like *Billy Jack* heralded a new fight against injustice, not just in the movies, but in real life as well, with First Nations people politically asserting themselves by seizing Alcatraz Island and Wounded Knee to recapture their land and freedom. Hollywood would in turn come to the rescue: Marlon Brando refusing to show up at the Academy Awards to protest against "the poor treatment of Native Americans in the film industry" and the FBI's actions at Wounded Knee. Sacheen Cruz Littlefeather would be Brando's messenger, asking the government to change its treatment of North American Indians. After that turning point, productions like *One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest* and many others would forever change the way "Injuns" are depicted on screen.

12. In the 1970s, the US government infiltrated a tribal council (on the Pine Ridge Indian Reservation in the town of Wounded Knee) and in 1973 AIM activists seized the town. Retrace the framework of events that led to the uprising. /3

No More stereotypes and stoic Indians The Renaissance – Chapter 8 @ 1:13:00mins.

Main points: Even though the government had wiped out the Native political movement by the 1980s, a cultural artistic voice emerged, composed of Native filmmakers, songwriters and visual artists. Smoke Signals, directed by and starring Native people, ushered in the golden age of Aboriginal cinema. The story was not about what occurred one hundred years ago but about current-day “nativeness,” where there are no stereotypes and no stoic Indians.

After travelling the United States in search of the truth, filmmaker Neil Diamond found the answers he was looking for in the Far North of Turtle Island (a.k.a. North America), in Igloodik. Atanarjuat, by Zacharias Kunuk, paved the way for a new generation of storytelling. A new age of cinema was born.

13. Director Neil Diamond mentioned that he found the answers he was looking for in the North. What exactly was the object of his quest? /2

On what basis can we say that Atanarjuat is the “most Native” movie ever made? /2

COMMUNITIES TODAY

It's Hard to Be Traditional (page 178-179)

11. What are some examples of the problems found in trying to be traditional in modern urban society as talked about in the song? /4

Life in Rural Aboriginal Communities (page 180-187)

12. How did stereotypes affect Jenine Dumont's self-esteem and self-confidence? /2

Reserve Life

13. Fill in the chart below to explore some of the benefits of living on a reserve: /8

	Benefits of Living on a Reserve
Family/ Friends	
Life's Pace	
Children	
Other Benefits	

14. Why did Robert Smallboy leave his reserve in 1968? /2

15. What percentage of reserves still lack electricity? /1
- a) 15
 - b) 12
 - c) 10
 - d) 5
16. Record how the following three problems affect reserve life: / 3
- Pollution:
- Youth at Risk:
- Television:

Métis and Inuit Communities

17. What is the difference between people from the Métis settlements in Alberta and other Métis communities near towns in other parts of the country? /3

Urban Communities (page 188-197)**The Draw of Urban Areas**

18. What is the most common reason Aboriginal people move to urban areas? /2

Urban Challenges

19. Why might First Nations unemployment in cities be so much higher than Non-Aboriginal Peoples? /2
20. How will a younger population of Aboriginal people help change the trends of Unemployment? /2
21. What is the goal of the urban Aboriginal Strategy and how does it work? /2

The Urban Policy Gap

22. What is the new direction of the Assembly of First Nations according to Chief Phil Fontaine? /1

Friendship Centres

23. How did friendship centres begin? /1
24. What are three benefits of friendship centres in urban areas? /3

Effective Services for Aboriginal People (page 198-205)

25. What is AHRDS and what does it do? /1
26. Why might Aboriginal services require significant time to develop? /1

Controversies

27. What is the problem with assuming that Aboriginal services place an unfair tax burden on the average citizen? /2

Devolving Services to Aboriginal Peoples

28. What is the difference between non-Aboriginal and Aboriginal health care Services? /2

Aboriginal Services for Aboriginal People

29. How did the Nunavut Sivuniksavut program begin and what does it do now? /2
30. What are two examples given in the textbook of Aboriginal services being provided by Aboriginal people? /2

Where is Attawapiskat?



This Northern community is in crisis. Although not all reserve communities are living like this, in fact we will look at a thriving community in our fourth module, but for now we need to take a closer look at what is happening in Attawapiskat.

This community was also home to youth leader Shannen Koostachin.



Shannen Koostachin is a contemporary Canadian who was from the Attawapiskat First Nation, a community on the shores of James Bay. She never had the opportunity to go to a real school. Promise after promise had been made to her and community members that they would build a school. She began speaking out about the conditions in her community and the portables they had been going to live in. She inspired other kids across Canada to get involved. She was part of the "Back of the Bus" movement or the children at the "back of the bus" experiences of her community in newspapers, on television, and in a play in 2008. At the age of 14, in 2009, she won the Children's Peace Prize. Shannen died in a fire on her sixteenth birthday. Out of the grief, a movement that had begun in Attawapiskat swept across the country. Students and teachers joined together to make Shannen's Dream come true. Like all heroes, Shannen's story is courageous, passionate and inspiring.

Assignment 3.3 Attawapiskat Report

Please visit the following document to learn about the issues in Attawapiskat. Read through the document, and use the additional links on the document as you see fit to learn more about the issue.

This document was made in 2011. The community has changed since then. Therefore, part of your task is to also conduct additional research to learn more about Attawapiskat

today. As part of your assignment, you must provide links to at least three sources (news articles, videos, reports, photos, etc) that are dated from 2023 onwards.

You will use the information from the provided document and your own research to complete the report.

Community Report



Attawapiskat is now seen as a community in crisis that is living in poor conditions. Explain this description using information from the document.

Your report **must include** the following elements:

- Current data dated at least 2015 and above
- Information regarding the suicide, housing, health care, etc. crisis
- What could the future hold?
- What could help this community?
- 3 current sources from 2023 or later.

Respond in any form you would like: paragraph form, letter, presentation, video, visual display. Just be sure to 'link' your final product to this document, or tell me where to find it.

/16

Type or write your response below, regardless of your mode of presentation you will be graded using the response criteria found on google classroom.

Mamihcimowewin !!!

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(Congratulations in Cree)

You have completed the third theme for this course! Please hand in this module, meet with your teacher, and begin working on module 4.

Aboriginal Studies 30

Theme Three

Student Completion Checklist

Assignment	Raw Score	Percentage Value	Points
3.0 Definitions and Short Answer Guiding Questions	/75	50%	
3.1 Breaking Stereotypes (Critical Response)	/16	15%	
3.2 Reel Injun	/30	20%	
3.3 Attawapiskat Report (Critical Response)	/16	15%	
Final Grade			/100

Comments: